# Naming Conventions

The standard for naming custom objects in the DBA database. Third-party objects are excluded — see Third-party exclusion.

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## Core rules

1. PascalCase for all custom objects.
2. Spell out ad-hoc abbreviations. `DB` → `Database`, `MEM` → `Memory`, `QRY` → `Query`.
3. Keep industry-standard abbreviations. `AG`, `RCSI`, `UDF`, `TVP`, `IO`, `CPU` are retained — they are universally understood in a SQL Server context.
4. Underscores separate logical name parts, e.g. `WaitStats_History`, `FileStat_Database_Delta`.

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## Prefixes by object type

| Prefix | Applies to | Example |
|---|---|---|
| `usp_` | Custom stored procedures | `usp_Monitor_CaptureWaitStats` |
| `vw_` | Views | `vw_WaitStats_Current` |
| `fn_` | Scalar / table-valued functions | `fn_AG_IsPrimary` |
| `tvp_` | User-defined table types (TVPs) | `tvp_JobDef` |
| (none) | Tables — descriptive noun phrase | `WaitStats_History` |

> Tables take no prefix. A table name should read as a description of its contents.

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## Procedure naming pattern

Custom procedures follow: `usp_<Domain>_<VerbNoun>`

- **Domain** groups the procedure by function: `Monitor`, `Jobs`, `Report`, `Diag`. It is a naming prefix only — the repository folder is the procedure's subject domain (see the Domain Reference Guide).
- **VerbNoun** describes the action: `CaptureWaitStats`, `DeployJob`, `DatabaseSizing`.

Examples:

| Procedure | Repository folder |
|---|---|
| `usp_Monitor_CaptureWaitStats` | `06_programmability/procedures/waitstats/` |
| `usp_Monitor_CaptureFileStats` | `06_programmability/procedures/filestat/` |
| `usp_Jobs_DeployJob` | `06_programmability/procedures/jobs_framework/` |
| `usp_Report_DatabaseSizing` | `06_programmability/procedures/instance/` |
| `usp_Diag_WhoIsActiveOpenTran` | `06_programmability/procedures/activity/` |

When a multi-step Agent job is broken into one procedure per step, the shared function prefix keeps the related procedures grouped in names even though they live in their subject-domain folders and separate job steps call them.

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## View naming pattern

Views follow: `vw_<Domain>_<Description>`

Views are filed by subject domain under `05_views/<domain>/`: `activity`, `blocking`, `waitstats`, `filestat`, `rcsi`, `memory`, `io`, `cpu`, `instance`, `query`, `workload_metrics`, `blitz_scc`, `admin`.

Examples: `vw_CPU_TopSessions`, `vw_Memory_BufferPoolUsage`, `vw_WaitStats_Current`.

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## Avoid

- **ALL_CAPS object names** — e.g. `WHOISACTIVE_OUTPUT` → `WhoIsActive_Output`.
- **Mixed-case inconsistency in prefixes** — e.g. `vw_INSTANCE_*` and `vw_MEM_*` → `vw_Instance_*`, `vw_Memory_*`.
- **Informal names** — e.g. `usp_whatsup` → `usp_Monitor_InstanceHealthSummary`.
- **Generic single-word names** — e.g. `Queue` → `Jobs_Queue` (qualify so the name is meaningful on its own).
- **Misspellings carried forward** — fix them during the rename (e.g. `Sesion` → `Session`).
- **A missing prefix** — every custom view starts `vw_` and every custom procedure `usp_`.

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## Third-party exclusion

Objects in `02_third_party/` are never renamed. This includes the entire Brent Ozar suite (`sp_Blitz`, `sp_BlitzCache`, `sp_BlitzIndex`, `sp_BlitzWho`, `sp_ineachdb`, `sp_kill`, `SqlServerVersions`, etc.), the Ola Hallengren solution (`DatabaseBackup`, `DatabaseIntegrityCheck`, `IndexOptimize`, `CommandExecute`, `CommandLog`), Adam Machanic's `sp_WhoIsActive`, and Erik Darling's utilities (`sp_HumanEvents`, `sp_PressureDetector`, `sp_QuickieStore`, etc.).

Their internal cross-references, community documentation, and upstream update mechanisms all depend on their exact published names. Renaming them would break functionality and sever the link to updates.

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## Applying renames safely

1. **Search first.** Before renaming any table or procedure, search `msdb.dbo.sysjobsteps` and dependent code for references to the old name (`tools/find_old_name_references.sql` does this).
2. **Procedures/views/functions:** prefer DROP + CREATE in a transaction over `sp_rename` (which leaves metadata inconsistencies on programmable objects). A transitional synonym or `CREATE OR ALTER` under the old name can bridge consumers during cutover.
3. **TVPs last.** Renaming a table type forces recompilation of every procedure that declares a parameter of that type. Do these after dependent procedures are updated.
4. **The complete current → proposed mapping** for every object is in the Object Naming Reference.